

CFES

CANADIAN FEDERATION OF ENGINEERING STUDENTS



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LA FÉDÉRATION CANADIENNE DES ÉTUDIANT.E.S EN GÉNIE

Canadian Federation of Engineering Students

Document of Stances

English Edition

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Quality of Engineering Internships

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The Official Stance:

The Canadian Federation of Engineering Students believes that the quality of engineering internship programs across Canada is inconsistent and often substandard, and that engineering programs have a responsibility to revise their practices in order to offer students a better value for their program fees.

The Students' Position

- Student satisfaction with internship program quality is low across Canada, representing general dissatisfaction with the value of internship services offered at engineering schools including opportunities, resources provided and accessibility.
- The lack of regulation across engineering internship programs leads to greater variation and lower standards for the services that are offered to students, compared to other areas of engineering education.
- The flaws in internship programs vary considerably across institutions, meaning that an effective response to internship program issues must occur on a localized basis.

Recommendations to Partners, Stakeholders, and Other Entities

- Student satisfaction with internship program quality is low across Canada, representing general dissatisfaction with the value of internship services offered at engineering schools including opportunities, resources provided and accessibility.
- The lack of regulation across engineering internship programs leads to greater variation and lower standards for the services that are offered to students, compared to other areas of engineering education.
- The flaws in internship programs vary considerably across institutions, meaning that an effective response to internship program issues must occur on a localized basis.

What the CFES is doing

- The CFES included internship quality as a focus area for its 2017 National Student Survey and its associated research, in order to determine the scope of internship program issues across Canada.

- The CFES included internship and professional development questions in the 2023 National Survey to determine the requirements surrounding internship and resources available from institutions.

What the CFES plans to do

- The CFES will work with its partners to create resources for sharing basic information about engineering program practices across Canada, and for advocating to faculties for effective changes.
- The CFES will investigate the merits of advocating to Co-operative Education and Work-Integrated Learning Canada to improve their accreditation of mandatory engineering internship programs.
- The CFES will bring back data collected by the National Survey regarding internships to Engineering Deans Canada in order to provide direction to their individual programs.
- The CFES will work with the regional organizations (WESST, ESSCO, QCESO, ACES) to gain information at a regional level of common engineering internship practice and policy.